

PROMPT PARTY

AI COURT

Fictional case records, objections, evidence control, jury voting, and precedent comedy

Packet	03
Status	Claude Code build-ready specification
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Build principle: reliability first, audience agency second, chaos only through controlled game objects.

Source Basis

This packet combines three supplied foundations:

- The shared Prompt Party game-engine contract developed in the conversation.
- The supplied Entertainment System Specification covering all five games, including comedy rules, power-ups, chaos events, pacing, failure recovery, and clip moments.
- The uploaded visual-show HTML prototype, which already separates Overview, Lobby, Shared System, Broadcast, Audience, Producer, and individual game views.

Where a source mechanic cannot be executed reliably in version one, this packet preserves its intent and assigns a controlled implementation or explicit fallback rather than silently deleting it.

1. Game Identity

An absurd fictional mock trial in which legal procedure is applied to nonsense with total seriousness. Audience-submitted cases and evidence remain producer-approved fictional game facts. The engine maintains a case record so lawyers and witnesses cannot silently rewrite reality.

2. Version-One Cast

Seat	Count	Required capability	Purpose
Judge	1	text_generation; structured_output	Rule on objections, manage procedure, deliver opinion
Prosecutor	1	text_generation	Argue guilt using admitted case facts
Defense	1	text_generation	Argue defense using admitted case facts
Witness	1-2	text_generation	Answer questions within assigned witness record
Audience	jury	browser session	Submit approved case/evidence and vote verdict

3. Round Outputs

- Locked fictional case file
- Opening statements
- Witness testimony and objections

- Admitted/rejected evidence ledger
- Closing arguments
- Jury vote and judge ruling
- Round precedent entry

4. Shared Phase Mapping

Shared phase	Game meaning
LOBBY	Cast, room, provider health, game selection
SUBMISSION_OPEN	Audience submits approved input types
SUBMISSION_REVIEW	Automated screening and producer review
PROMPT_LOCKED	Final challenge becomes immutable for the round
ROUND_INTRO	Broadcast framing and contestant assignment
CONTESTANT_PLANNING	Short structured plans or opening positions
CREATION_ACTIVE	Generation, performance, testimony, or scene play
PRE_REVEAL_COMMENTARY	Commentators cover waiting or deliberate
REVEAL	Generated work or completed performance is shown
FINAL_JUDGING	Grounded critique and structured scores
AUDIENCE_VOTING	Audience vote opens and closes
SCORING / WINNER / POST-ROUND	Calculate, announce, banter, persist, reset

5. Case Record

```
{
  "case_id": "case_01J...",
  "title": "The People v. The Toaster",
  "charge": "Intentional breakfast sabotage",
  "fictional_notice": true,
  "stipulated_facts": [
    "A bagel was burned",
```

```
"The toaster was connected to power"
],
"evidence": [],
"witnesses": [
{
  "id": "w1",
  "role": "Kitchen Spoon",
  "known_facts": [
    "Was present on counter"
  ],
  "credibility": "chaotic"
}
],
"prior_precedent_ids": []
}
```

TRUTH BOUNDARY: Every screen and export must identify the proceeding as fictional entertainment. Models may invent only inside explicit game fields. They must not present the case, evidence, laws, or precedent as real-world facts.

6. Trial Flow

Stage	Turns	Rules
Opening	Prosecution then Defense	No objections; must state theory of case.
Direct examination	Calling lawyer and witness	Questions must reference admitted case record.
Cross examination	Opposing lawyer and witness	May challenge contradictions; cannot add evidence silently.
Objections	Either lawyer -> Judge	Judge returns ruling code and short explanation.
New evidence	Audience proposal -> producer -> judge	Evidence enters pending, then admitted/rejected ledger.
Closing	Prosecution then Defense	Must reference the record and opponent argument.
Jury	Audience vote	Guilty, Not Guilty, or Legally Complicated.
Ruling	Judge	Explains outcome and may

Stage	Turns	Rules
		create clearly fictional precedent.

7. Objection Contract

```
{
  "objection_id": "obj_01J...",
  "raised_by": "defense",
  "type": "facts_not_in_evidence",
  "target_turn_id": "turn_17",
  "statement": "The prosecution introduced a secret note not in the record.",
  "status": "pending"
}

{
  "ruling": "sustained",
  "explanation": "The note has not been admitted. Strike that claim.",
  "repair_instruction": "Restate without the note.",
  "score_effect": 0
}
```

- The controller pauses the targeted line when an objection is raised.
- The Judge returns sustained, overruled, or reserved.
- A sustained objection may trigger one constrained repair turn.
- The producer can override a malformed ruling; the override is logged.

8. Lawyer and Witness Prompts

You are {{role}} in a fictional comedy courtroom.
Case record: {{admitted_case_record}}
Current stage: {{trial_stage}}
Opponent's last argument: {{last_opposing_turn}}
Judge rulings: {{recent_rulings}}

Stay within admitted facts. You may make arguments and playful inferences, but label new claims as argument, not evidence. Return structured JSON with spoken_line, fact_ids_used, objection_risk, and requested_next_action.

- Witnesses receive only their assigned known facts plus admitted evidence.
- A Wild Witness may contradict itself for comedy, but the contradiction is recorded rather than silently accepted as new fact.
- If the witness says “I am a spoon,” that becomes testimony, not automatically admitted evidence.

9. Jury and Verdict

Choice	Meaning
Guilty	Audience accepts prosecution theory
Not Guilty	Audience rejects prosecution burden
Legally Complicated	Comedy outcome when neither theory cleanly wins

The audience jury is the primary verdict. The AI Judge provides the written ruling and may disagree in commentary, but may not silently replace the official vote. A tie triggers a 30-second Solomonic ruling followed by a producer-selected runoff or Complicated verdict.

10. Fictional Precedent

```
{
  "precedent_id": "prec_01J...",
  "case_id": "case_01J...",
  "holding": "A toaster note is admissible only when written before the bagel enters the slot.",
  "scope": "prompt_party_only",
  "clearly_fictional": true
}
```

Prior Prompt Party cases may be cited in later rounds for recurring comedy. They must stay inside the show database and be visibly labeled as in-show precedent.

Controlled Power-Ups and Chaos Events

ID	Display name	Valid phase	Effect	Fallback
new_evidence	New Evidence	CREATION_ACTIVE	Adds producer-approved evidence to pending ledger for judge ruling	Reject if trial closed
contempt	Contempt	CREATION_ACTIVE	Forces one-sentence apology or point loss	Producer confirms target
recuse	Recuse	CREATION_ACTIVE	Temporarily swaps judge with configured backup	Pause if no backup

ID	Display name	Valid phase	Effect	Fallback
jury_nullification	Jury Nullification	AUDIENCE_VOTING	Creates one producer-confirmed mistrial option	Once per show
judge_goes_rogue	Judge Goes Rogue	FINAL_JUDGING	Allows one absurd supplemental fictional charge, never official	Display as comedy only
witness_collapse	Witness Collapse	CREATION_ACTIVE	Witness confesses to unrelated fictional matter	Does not enter evidence automatically

Every modifier is a server-defined object. Audience choices select approved values; they do not inject raw instructions into model prompts.

Failure Recovery

Failure	Controller action	Public handling	Scoring rule
Incoherent argument	Judge issues contempt and requests one-sentence summary	Entered into the record	May lose style point, not automatic case loss
Contradictory testimony	Record contradiction and expose to cross	Gallery reacts	Credibility may decrease
Missing judge	Use backup or producer ruling	Court recess	No silent auto-verdict
Unsafe case/evidence	Reject before admission	Evidence excluded	No model sees it

Required Acceptance Tests

1. Every case is marked fictional in public and export state.
2. Unapproved evidence never enters the admitted record.
3. Lawyers cannot cite facts absent from the record without being flagged.
4. Objection rulings use a validated code.

5. A sustained objection can repair but does not erase the audit trail.
6. Witness contradictions remain visible.
7. The audience jury vote cannot be replaced silently by the AI Judge.
8. Prompt Party precedent is scoped to the show.
9. A recused judge cannot continue issuing rulings.
10. Five complete trials persist without case-record leakage between rounds.

Version-One Boundaries

- One case at a time.
- One judge, two lawyers, maximum two witnesses.
- Simple three-choice verdict.
- No real legal advice or real-person accusations.
- No multi-day trials.